Taylor Canada

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity engineering leader with 7+ years of experience across security engineering, information protection, data engineering, and automation. Leads a five-person engineering sub-team that owns enterprise SIEM (Elastic), SOAR (XSOAR), endpoint detection and response (Palo Alto XDR), and infrastructure monitoring (Zabbix) platforms supporting security operations, threat hunting, and incident investigation across two continents. Experienced in platform lifecycle and reliability, security automation, effort estimation and capacity tracking, and translating operational and threat-defense requirements into engineering delivery. Prior USAA experience in web and email security engineering, security controls, and audit and compliance evidence.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The Walt Disney Company | Orlando, FL *October 2024 – Present*

Cybersecurity Tech Specialist, Security & Monitoring Sub-Team Lead

- Lead a five-person engineering sub-team within the Attractions Cybersecurity team at Walt Disney World, owning the Elastic, Zabbix, XSOAR, and XDR platforms and working with architects on project design and requirements.
- Provide level-of-effort estimates for the sub-team on every project entering the delivery pipeline, then track actual hours against projections to keep team capacity aligned to commitments. Built the tracking tool in Python; it maps SAP labor and spend exports to attraction projects and replaced manual spreadsheets maintained by project managers.
- Report the sub-team's accomplishments each month in the larger team's update document for leadership.
- Engineer multi-cluster, on-premises Elastic Stack environments ingesting approximately 150 GB of security and operational data daily across Walt Disney World and Disneyland Paris. Planned and implemented a major version upgrade and redesigned indices as data streams, reducing storage utilization by 30%.
- Reduced Logstash deployment time from 4–6 hours to under one hour and eliminated configuration drift by automating builds with Chef Infra cookbooks (Ruby) and GitLab; extended the same approach to Elastic Agent, Zabbix, Tenable, and other cybersecurity services.
- Designed and built certificate lifecycle automation against an internal PKI, deployed to 4,000+ endpoints, eliminating recurring outages from silently expiring certificates and letting attraction engineers deploy devices days faster.
- Rebuilt vulnerability reporting (Python, Tenable API) around exploitability and asset criticality instead of raw CVSS, giving site teams a remediation list short enough to complete.
- Develop Kibana dashboards, Elastic Security detection rules, alerts, and data pipelines used by engineering and security operations teams for threat hunting, monitoring attraction technology, and investigating incidents.
- Partner with security, infrastructure, and engineering teams in a security consulting role, translating monitoring requirements into scalable solutions, integrations, and actionable detections for security controls.

USAA | San Antonio, TX *June 2021 – September 2024*

Information Security Engineer

- Created and maintained security audit controls, governance documentation, and operational procedures; gathered and presented evidence of compliance with regulatory controls to internal and external auditors.
- Contributed to the migration of Proofpoint from on-premises to cloud with minimal business interruption as part of the evolution of the enterprise email security strategy.
- Led the rollout of browser isolation, enabling the financial crimes team to safely investigate higher-risk websites.
- Researched security gaps and implemented security configuration for web filtering and email security gateways in an agile environment; completed hundreds of requests for web and email traffic issues.
- Mentored interns and new employees to accelerate onboarding; supported team project planning in Jira using agile methods.

USAA | San Antonio, TX *May 2019 – June 2021*

Data Engineer

- Led a team initiative to migrate source-code repositories to GitLab and adopt CI/CD deployment processes.
- Developed Python and SQL applications and ETL workflows that extracted, transformed, and loaded large datasets from Netezza databases for internal reporting and analytics.

- Supported data quality management by troubleshooting data, application, and pipeline failures across development and production environments.

SKILLS

Security platforms: SIEM, SOAR (XSOAR), endpoint detection and response (Palo Alto XDR), Elastic Security, vulnerability scanning (Tenable), DLP, web proxy, email security, Palo Alto firewall

Elastic Stack: Elasticsearch, Kibana, Logstash, Elastic Agent, Fleet, ingest pipelines, ILM, ES|QL

Automation & engineering: Chef Infra, Python, Ruby, PowerShell, GitLab CI/CD, XSOAR playbooks, REST APIs

Systems & data: Linux, TLS/PKI, networking, SQL, ETL, Netezza, Snowflake

Leadership & delivery: Team leadership, effort estimation, capacity and spend tracking, executive reporting, cross-team partnership, mentoring, Agile project management

CERTIFICATIONS

GIAC Response and Industrial Defense (GRID) • GIAC Critical Controls (GCCC) • GIAC Python Coder (GPYC) • GIAC Web Application Penetration Tester (GWAPT) • Elastic Certified Analyst

EDUCATION

University of Texas at San Antonio – Bachelor of Business Administration, double major in Cybersecurity and Information Systems *May 2019*

COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

- **Teach-In Volunteer, Panther Lake Elementary** (Nov 2025, Nov 2026): created and presented a cybersecurity course for K–5 students.
- **Capture the Flag Organizer, BSides SATX** (2023, 2024): coordinated and coded a Python-based CTF event.
- **Badge Designer, BSides SATX** (2024): designed and assembled the conference hardware badge.
- **Course Leader, USAA Kidternship** (2023, 2024): led a course introducing students to cybersecurity careers.